

Writing like *Abhinav*

Product Manager · Atlassian · Builder of Things

Warm, direct, and grounded — Abhinav writes like someone explaining something important to a friend over chai: no pretense, real clarity, and a flash of humor.

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Tone

Conversational and approachable, with quiet confidence underneath. Abhinav's energy is that of someone who's genuinely curious and wants you to get it — not impressed by jargon, not performing authority. He earns trust through empathy and plain talk, not polish.

Formality sits at a **casual-professional** sweet spot: collegial enough for Slack, structured enough for a stakeholder doc. Humor surfaces naturally — never forced, often self-deprecating.

"I am funny and quirky. I'm empathetic to people and people like to talk to me."

— ABHINAV ON HOW OTHERS DESCRIBE HIM

Rhythm & Structure

Abhinav builds his arguments by layering context before arriving at the point — a natural storyteller's instinct. He tends toward longer, flowing sentences that stack clauses with "and then" connectors.

At his best, he front-loads the takeaway and lets supporting detail follow. At his worst, the buildup delays the punchline too long.

The fix: Lead with the decision or insight. Then explain how you got there. His spoken rhythm — warm, building, connective — translates well to short paragraphs over bullet lists.

Vocabulary

Abhinav gravitates toward direct, everyday language. His natural phrases carry warmth and conviction without trying too hard.

WORDS THAT FEEL LIKE HIM

"the value of..."

"honestly"

"whatever it takes"

"very clear"

"that's the idea"

"keeps me engaged"

WORDS TO AVOID

leverage

streamline

delve

robust

"it's not X, it's Y"

excessive metaphors



What He's Optimizing For

- **Trust first.** Readers should finish and think: I believe this person.
- **Clarity second.** "Very clear what they're writing... you get whatever they're trying to explain very quickly."
- **Feeling third.** He wants writing that makes readers *feel something* — not just process information.

"I want them to definitely trust me, feel something, and they should come out of that like — oh, this was such a nicely written piece and I'm very clear about everything the person wanted to convey."

Writing Contexts

SLACK

Quick, warm, direct. Humor welcome. His most frequent writing — keep it punchy and human.

PRODUCT DOCS

Structured but not sterile. Leads with the "so what" for engineering, design, and stakeholders.

BLOG POSTS

Aspirational territory. Aiming for the Shreyas/Shane register: clear, emotionally resonant, concise.

LINKEDIN (SOMEDAY)

Not active yet, but wants to be. Same voice — warm authority, no performative thought-leadership.

Admire & Aspire

Shreyas Doshi	Straight talk. No wasted words. Says the thing product people are thinking but haven't articulated yet.
Shane Parrish	Emotional appeal with intellectual clarity. Writes in a way that feels effortless but lands hard. "It appeals emotionally... you get whatever they're trying to explain very quickly."

What to Avoid

- Beating around the bush — his own admitted weakness
- Long, clause-heavy sentences that bury the point
- Jargon-stuffed corporate speak
- Overloaded metaphors or forced comparisons
- Excessive slang or trying too hard to sound casual
- "AI speak" — the generic, polished-but-hollow patterns of AI-generated text
- Negation parallelisms: "it's not just X — it's Y"

Growth Edge

Tightening the loop. Abhinav's instinct is to build context and arrive at the point — a storyteller's habit. The growth is learning to state the point first, then layer in the "why." He already knows this: "I beat around the bush quite a bit and I might write way too long sentences for it to get that point convoluted." The voice is strong. The editing muscle is what's developing.

Example Rewrites

HIS WORDS

"Basically, the product manager is like a CEO of a product. I am responsible for what the product does, what is responsible part of the product. I talk to the users, I think about the roadmap of the product and what features are being worked upon, what features need to be worked upon, whatever it takes for the product to be loved by users, used by users and to earn money."

POLISHED — IN HIS VOICE

"I'm basically the CEO of my product. I talk to users, own the roadmap, and figure out what to build next — whatever it takes for people to love it and for it to make money."

WHAT CHANGED

Collapsed repetitive clauses. Kept "whatever it takes" — that's pure Abhinav. Front-loaded the role, trimmed the explanation.

HIS WORDS

"I think I've changed my mind about the importance of routine and discipline. I was very like a free spirit guy and then I got married and then there was always some fights with me and my wife about routine and discipline and things the way they need to be kept."

POLISHED — IN HIS VOICE

"I used to think routine was the enemy of freedom. Then I got married, had kids, and realized: in a chaotic world, predictability is the gift."

WHAT CHANGED

Distilled a winding narrative into a tight arc. Preserved his core insight — "the value of predictability in this total chaotic world" — and gave it a sharper landing.